



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 5456

LCO No. 2460



Referred to Committee on PUBLIC SAFETY AND SECURITY

Introduced by:
(PS)

***AN ACT CONCERNING DEPUTY COMMISSIONERS OF THE
DEPARTMENT OF EMERGENCY SERVICES AND PUBLIC
PROTECTION.***

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Subsection (a) of section 29-1r of the general statutes is
2 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October*
3 *1, 2026*):

4 (a) (1) There is established a Department of Emergency Services and
5 Public Protection. Said department shall be the designated emergency
6 management and homeland security agency for the state. The
7 department head shall be the Commissioner of Emergency Services and
8 Public Protection, who shall be appointed by the Governor in
9 accordance with sections 4-5 to 4-8, inclusive, with the powers and
10 duties prescribed in said sections. The commissioner shall be
11 responsible for providing a coordinated, integrated program for the
12 protection of life and property and for state-wide emergency
13 management and homeland security. The commissioner shall appoint
14 not more than [two] three deputy commissioners who shall, under the

15 direction of the commissioner, assist in the administration of the
16 department. Such deputy commissioners shall consist of a first deputy
17 commissioner and two operational deputy commissioners, as follows:

18 (A) The first deputy commissioner shall be the Deputy Commissioner
19 of Administration, and shall be responsible for department-wide
20 oversight of policy matters, legislative affairs and budgetary
21 coordination.

22 (B) The two operational deputy commissioners shall be (i) the Deputy
23 Commissioner of Emergency Management, Fire and
24 Telecommunications, who shall be responsible for overseeing the
25 administration and operations of (I) the Division of Emergency
26 Management and Homeland Security, (II) the Division of Fire Services
27 Administration, and (III) the Division of State-wide Emergency
28 Telecommunications, and (ii) the Deputy Commissioner of Public Safety
29 and Training, who shall be responsible for overseeing the
30 administration and operations of (I) the Division of State Police, (II) the
31 Police Officer Standards and Training Council, and (III) the Division of
32 Scientific Services.

33 (2) The commissioner may do all things necessary to apply for,
34 qualify for and accept any federal funds made available or allotted
35 under any federal act for emergency management or homeland security.

36 Sec. 2. Section 29-1b of the general statutes is repealed and the
37 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

38 (a) There shall be within the Department of Emergency Services and
39 Public Protection a Division of State Police. The Commissioner of
40 Emergency Services and Public Protection shall serve as administrative
41 head and commanding officer of the State Police Division. As
42 administrative head, said commanding officer of the Division of State
43 Police shall delegate said commanding officer's jurisdiction of the affairs
44 of the Division of State Police to [a deputy commissioner] the Deputy
45 Commissioner of Public Safety and Training, who shall have the powers

46 and privileges conferred by statute upon a state policeman.

47 (b) There shall be within said department a Division of Emergency
48 Management and Homeland Security. The commissioner shall serve as
49 administrative head of said division. As administrative head, said
50 commissioner shall delegate said commissioner's jurisdiction of the
51 Division of Emergency Management and Homeland Security to [a
52 deputy commissioner. The] the Deputy Commissioner of Emergency
53 Management, Fire and Telecommunications. Said deputy commissioner
54 shall possess professional training and knowledge consisting of not less
55 than five years of managerial or strategic planning experience in matters
56 relating to public safety, security, emergency services and emergency
57 response. No person possessing a record of any criminal, unlawful or
58 unethical conduct shall be eligible for or hold such position. Any person
59 with any present or past political activities or financial interests that may
60 substantially conflict with the duties of [the] said deputy commissioner
61 or expose such person to potential undue influence or compromise such
62 person's ability to be entrusted with necessary state or federal security
63 clearances or information shall be deemed unqualified for such position
64 and shall not be eligible to hold such position.

65 (c) (1) There shall be within said department a Division of Fire
66 Services Administration. The State Fire Administrator shall be the
67 administrative head of said division and shall report to the Deputy
68 Commissioner of Emergency Management, Fire and
69 Telecommunications.

70 (2) The functions, powers, duties and personnel of the former Office
71 of State Fire Administration shall be transferred to the Division of Fire
72 Services Administration pursuant to the provisions of sections 4-38d
73 and 4-39.

74 (3) The Division of Fire Services Administration shall constitute the
75 successor to the Office of State Fire Administration in accordance with
76 the provisions of sections 4-38d, 4-38e and 4-39. Wherever the words

77 "Office of State Fire Administration" are used in the general statutes, the
78 words "Division of Fire Services Administration within the Department
79 of Emergency Services and Public Protection" shall be substituted in lieu
80 thereof. Any order or regulation of the former Office of State Fire
81 Administration that is in force on July 1, 2025, shall continue in force
82 and effect as an order or regulation of the Division of Fire Services
83 Administration within the Department of Emergency Services and
84 Public Protection until amended, repealed or superseded pursuant to
85 law.

86 Sec. 3. Subsection (a) of section 29-7b of the general statutes is
87 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October*
88 *1, 2026*):

89 (a) There shall be within the Department of Emergency Services and
90 Public Protection a Division of Scientific Services. The Commissioner of
91 Emergency Services and Public Protection shall serve as administrative
92 head of such division, and [may] shall delegate jurisdiction over the
93 affairs of such division to [a deputy commissioner] the Deputy
94 Commissioner of Public Safety and Training.

95 Sec. 4. Subdivision (11) of section 4-37f of the 2026 supplement to the
96 general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu
97 thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

98 (11) If the foundation is established for the principal purpose of
99 coordinated emergency recovery, the Department of Emergency
100 Services and Public Protection shall be deemed the state agency for
101 purposes of this section, and the [deputy commissioner of said
102 department with jurisdiction over the Division of Emergency
103 Management and Homeland Security] Deputy Commissioner of
104 Emergency Management, Fire and Telecommunications shall be
105 deemed the executive authority for purposes of this section.

106 Sec. 5. Subdivision (1) of subsection (b) of section 4-37s of the general
107 statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof

108 (Effective October 1, 2026):

109 (b) (1) CT CARE shall be administered by a governing board. The
 110 board shall include the following voting members: (A) Seven members
 111 appointed by the Governor who shall have experience in finance or
 112 accounting or with the operation of a nonprofit or other corporation,
 113 each of whom shall serve at the pleasure of the Governor; (B) the
 114 Secretary of the Office of Policy and Management, or the secretary's
 115 designee; (C) the Deputy Commissioner of Emergency [Services and
 116 Public Protection with jurisdiction over the Division of Emergency
 117 Management and Homeland Security] Management, Fire and
 118 Telecommunications, or the deputy commissioner's designee; (D) an
 119 employee of the Office of Victim Services within the Judicial
 120 Department appointed by the Chief Court Administrator; (E) the
 121 chairperson of each regional emergency planning team established by
 122 the Division of Emergency Management and Homeland Security within
 123 the Department of Emergency Services and Public Protection; and (F)
 124 two members, appointed by the Connecticut Council for Philanthropy,
 125 each of whose term shall be coterminous with that of the Governor,
 126 provided such member's term shall extend through the duration of an
 127 eligible incident and, after expiration of such member's term, through
 128 any period in which a new appointment to replace such member has yet
 129 to be made.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:

Section 1	October 1, 2026	29-1r(a)
Sec. 2	October 1, 2026	29-1b
Sec. 3	October 1, 2026	29-7b(a)
Sec. 4	October 1, 2026	4-37f(11)
Sec. 5	October 1, 2026	4-37s(b)(1)

Statement of Purpose:

To (1) increase to three the number of deputy commissioners of the Department of Emergency Services and Public Protection, and (2) establish the responsibilities of such deputy commissioners.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]